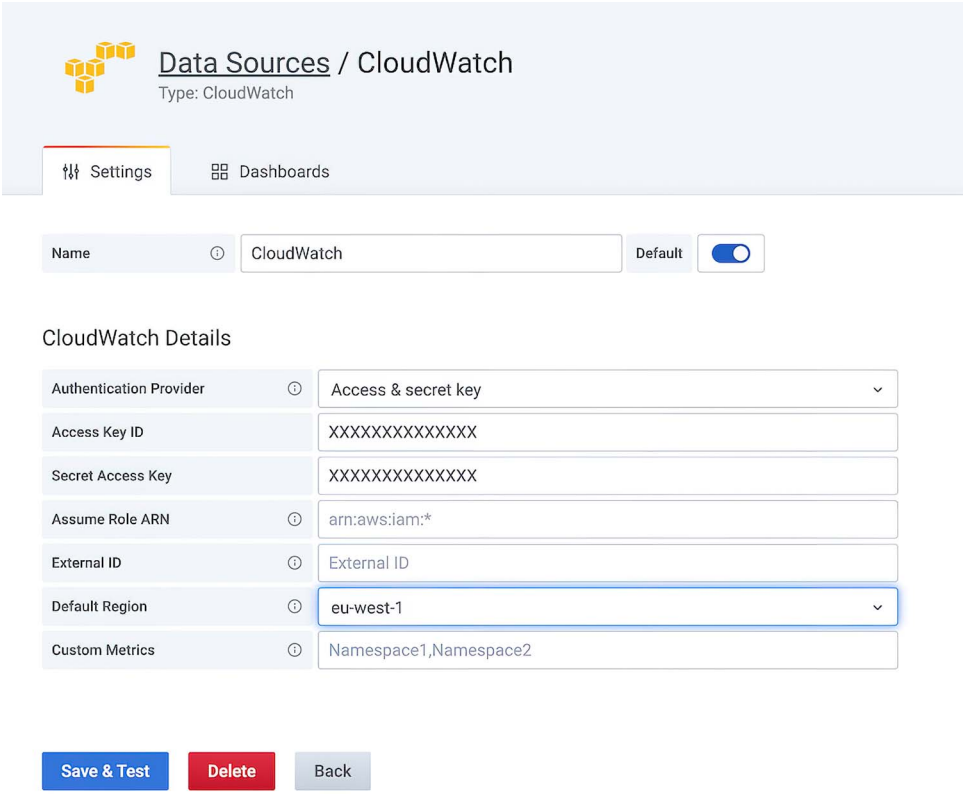


Figure 6.1 An example Grafana data source, showing configuration options

condition: if it passes, you can move on (e.g., using Explore to issue a test query against the data source). If it doesn't pass, you want to check connectivity and whether you have access to the data source, such as by checking IAM roles or API keys.

Grafana dashboards (https://grafana.com/docs/grafana/latest/dashboards/) group panels (https://grafana.com/docs/grafana/latest/panels/), supporting a variety of visualizations (https://grafana.com/docs/grafana/latest/visualizations/), from time series plots to heatmaps to bar charts that are organized into (collapsible) rows. You can make your dashboards much more reusable and flexible by using variables (https://grafana.com/docs/grafana/latest/dashboards/variables/) in a dashboard.

Let's see that in action: first, create a new dashboard (click the menu item that shows four squares with the title Dashboards), and there, click New Dashboard. Now, pick the gear symbol in the upper-right icons row that has the label Dashboard Settings. You should see the dashboard settings now; there (on the left-hand tab selection), click Variables. Here, you can create a new variable by clicking the Add